

Junho Kim

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Research Fields

International Trade, Political Economy, Geopolitics

Education

Indiana University Bloomington Bloomington, IN
Ph.D. in Economics, Expected May 2027

Indiana University Bloomington Bloomington, IN
M.A. in Economics, 2025

Yonsei University Seoul, South Korea
B.A. in Economics, 2014

Working Papers

“Tariffs as Economic Statecraft: Evidence from the Hegemon-Periphery Relationship”
(Job Market Paper) *with Mostafa Beshkar*

Abstract: Tariffs have long been understood as a tool of economic statecraft, used not only to manage trade but to extract political returns from trading partners. This may be why tariff-cut commitments so often look lopsided: a hegemon may offer periphery countries deeper cuts than it receives in return, with the imbalance possibly compensated on a different margin, namely political concessions. Using the United States as the hegemon and UN General Assembly voting as our measure of political concessions, we measure economic concessions as the terms-of-trade effect of bilateral tariff cuts and exploit variation in their value over time. We find that periods of larger tariff concessions from the US are also periods of greater political concessions by periphery countries. This holds even absent new tariff policy: a tariff schedule’s economic value is continuously revalued by shifting trade patterns, and the political returns to a concession made years earlier track this revaluation.

“Trade Imbalances and Reciprocity in the WTO: A Rule-Based Adjustment Framework” *with Mostafa Beshkar*

“Rebalancing Sourcing Networks after a Geopolitical Shock ”
(Draft available upon request)

Work in Progress

“Geopolitical Risk and Domestic Innovation”

“Political Shocks, Exit, and the Stability of the WTO”

Policy Papers

“Steady Growth of the Pharmaceutical Industry in Chungbuk”

BOK Golden Book, Bank of Korea, December 2018.

“Protectionism Status and Its Impact on Korean Exports” *with J. Park and B. Kim*
Economic Outlook, Bank of Korea, January 2017.

“Import Growth Outlook of Trading Partners Considering Changes in the Global Trade Structure” *with H. Lee*
Economic Outlook, Bank of Korea, October 2016.

Presentations

Hoosier Economics Conference 2024

Teaching Experience

Indiana University Bloomington

Assistant Instructor

Fundamentals of Economics for Business II Spring 2025, Fall 2025

Teaching Assistant

Fundamentals of Economics II Spring 2026

Introduction to Macroeconomics Spring 2026

Fundamentals of Economics for Business II Summer 2025

Introduction to Applied Econometrics Fall 2024, Fall 2022

Fundamentals of Economics for Business I Spring 2024, Fall 2023

Statistical Analysis for Business and Economics Spring 2023

Intermediate Microeconomic Theory Fall 2022

Research Experience

Research Assistant to Prof. Mostafa Beshkar Summer 2025

Professional Experience

Bank of Korea

Economist 2020–2022

Office of Bank Examination

Junior Economist 2014–2019

Economic Statistics Department, Research Department, and Chungbuk Branch

Fellowships, Honors & Awards

Lloyd Orr Graduate Fellowship, Indiana University Fall 2026

Tobias Center Research Fund Grant, Indiana University Fall 2025

Susan C. Thrasher Fellowship, Indiana University Spring 2025, Fall 2025

Governor’s Encouragement Award, Bank of Korea June 2019

Skills

Programming: MATLAB, Stata, R, Python

Languages: English (Fluent), Korean (Native)

References

Mostafa Beshkar(Chair)

Associate Professor

Department of Economics, Indiana University

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Gustavo Torrens

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Emerson C. Melo

Associate Professor

Department of Economics, Indiana University

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Sarah Bauerle Danzman

Associate Professor

International Studies, Indiana University

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